

BUILD IT ONCE, FILL IT WITH AI IN 15 MINUTES

Substitute Binder with AI

Not another sub-plan template — the whole system. Six binder sections that cover everything a substitute needs, a master AI prompt for the content that changes every time, and a maintenance rhythm so the binder is never three units out of date when you actually need it.

BEFORE ANYTHING ELSE, THE RULE

No student names or personal details ever go into the prompt.

Rosters and seating charts live on paper in the binder, not in the chatbot.

What's in this pack

- The 6-tab binder system — exactly what goes behind each divider, and why.
- The master day-drafter prompt — one prompt, a complete sub day.
- Five section-fill prompts — one per divider, to draft the content that changes.
- The quarterly refresh checklist — fifteen minutes, four times a year, and the binder never goes stale.
- Print & assembly guide — from PDF to a binder by the door.

The 6-tab binder system

Six sections cover every question a sub actually asks. Build once; refresh, don't rebuild.

TAB 1

Daily Schedule

Bell times, where the sub goes each period, duty coverage, the day's special events.

TAB 2

Rosters & Seating

Printed class lists and seating charts — names live here, on paper, never in the AI.

TAB 3

Emergency Procedures

Fire, lockdown, evacuation map, and the office/nurse extensions a sub will need fast.

TAB 4

Ready-to-Grab Activity

One no-copier, no-login backup activity per prep, for the day everything else fails.

TAB 5
Class Routines & Culture

Entering, dismissal, signals, and a one-page "how this room runs."

TAB 6
Today's Lesson

The one thing that changes every time — filled in fresh, the morning you need it.

The master day-drafter prompt

A full sub day, drafted for a stranger

"You are an experienced [GRADE/SUBJECT] teacher writing plans for a substitute who has never met these students and may not know the subject. Today's classes: [LIST PERIODS AND LENGTHS]. We are currently studying [TOPIC/UNIT]. Write a complete sub plan: for each period, a 5-minute bell-ringer, one main activity with numbered student-facing directions, an early-finisher task, and how to collect work. Nothing that needs a copier, a login, or subject expertise. Tone: calm and specific. End with a three-line note the sub can leave me about how it went."

Print the result straight into Tab 6 — it's the only tab that changes every time you're out.

Five prompts, one per tab

Tab 1 · Turn your schedule into a sub-readable page

"Format this bell schedule into a clean, large-print one-pager for a substitute: [PASTE SCHEDULE]. Add a one-line note under each period about where the sub should be and what's different that day, if anything."

Tab 3 · The emergency quick-reference card

"Turn this into a large-print emergency quick-reference card for a substitute: [PASTE YOUR FIRE/LOCKDOWN PROCEDURES AND KEY PHONE NUMBERS]. One line per procedure, boldest text for what to do first."

Tab 4 · The no-tech backup activity

"Give me one paper-and-pencil backup activity per prep for [GRADE/SUBJECTS], each tied loosely to the general curriculum, zero technology, zero copier — something a sub can run cold with directions printed right on the page."

Tab 5 · The "how this room runs" page

"Write a short 'how this class runs' page for a substitute: routines for entering, bathroom, and turning in work: [DESCRIBE YOUR ROUTINES]. Do not reference any individual student — I keep those notes separately."

Tab 6 · The review-day fallback

"Instead of new content, make this a review day on [LAST TOPIC]: a 15-question mixed review students can do independently, an answer key on a separate page, and one partner activity that stays quiet. Use when I'm too sick to describe today's plan."

The quarterly refresh checklist

Fifteen minutes, four times a year — the binder stays current instead of going stale.

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|---|-------|
| ☐ Swap the roster and seating chart for every class you teach. | 5 min |
| ☐ Update the schedule page if bell times, duties, or specials changed. | 3 min |
| ☐ Re-check emergency numbers against the current staff directory. | 2 min |
| ☐ Refresh the backup activity if your unit or grade level moved on. | 3 min |
| ☐ Ask a colleague to glance through it — a second set of eyes catches what you'd miss. | 2 min |

Print & assembly

- **Print** the cover page, six tab dividers, and every prompt output on card stock if you have it — it holds up to a binder better.
- **Assemble** in a standard three-ring binder, cover page in the front pocket, dividers in tab order, Tab 6 loaded fresh each time you're planning to be out.
- **Store it** somewhere your building sub coordinator or front office knows to find it — the binder only works if someone can grab it at 5:30 a.m.

Never scramble on the family side either: our Parent Communication Log gives every student a page for contact history, right next to this binder on your shelf. In our TpT store.

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